



Istanbul European Choir
İstanbul Avrupa Korusu

ISTANBUL EUROPEAN CHOIR
Thessaloniki Project Sponsorship File

IEC, Turkey's award-winning major multi-cultural choir



IEC, Turkey's award-winning major multi-cultural choir



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Who is Istanbul European Choir?

Istanbul European Choir (IEC)

Established in early 1960s, **IEC is the longest-standing amateur choir of Istanbul** with its more than 70 choir members from different backgrounds, ages, professions, religions and nations, **representing the city of Istanbul's unique multi-cultural texture.**

Labeled as «**Choir of the Year**» and «**Classical Music Society of the Year**» within prestigious Donizetti Classical Music Awards in 2013, IEC is also known for having performed several premieres in Turkey.

Burak Onur Erdem is the conductor of IEC since September 2013 and Lena Şenol is the répétiteur of the choir since 2010.



Who is Istanbul European Choir?

Istanbul European Choir (IEC)

For more details about IEC, please visit:

facebook.com/avrupakorosu, twitter.com/isteurochoir

www.istanbulavrupakorosu.org, www.istanbuleuropeanchoir.org

For interview videos with our choir members, please click:

<http://on.fb.me/1sjuzxt>

<http://on.fb.me/VwgVPQ>

Who is Istanbul European Choir?

History of Istanbul European Choir (IEC)

IEC was originally established by the German community of Istanbul in the early 1960s under the name of “Deutscher Singkreis” (German Choir), and it was naturally renamed as “**Istanbul European Choir**” in 1991 after a group of French singers joined. Since then, the choir has grown into the country’s largest amateur independent choir, with more than seventy members from all kinds of backgrounds.

IEC has performed nearly forty major choral pieces since 1991, including several premieres in Turkey. **IEC** has given concerts with Istanbul State Symphony Orchestra (IDSO), led by distinguished conductors such as I. Ionescu Galati, Alexander Rahbari, Emre Aracı, Petr Vronski and Vesna Šouc.



What is the Thessaloniki Project?

The project has been initiated by the chairwoman of the Istanbul European Choir (IEC), Mrs. Lilli Zachariadou-İçgören, who had a vision of **creating a classical music exchange event between Thessaloniki**, her hometown, **and Istanbul**, where she resides. *This event involves joint concerts by the IEC and the Thessalonikis Choir (TC) in both cities.*

We are grateful that besides the IEC, and the TC's conductor Mrs. Mary Konstantinidou, the project found several supporters from the musical arena, mainly the enthusiastic Mr. Panagiotis Kountouris, the artistic manager of Megaro Mousikis Thessalonikis, who played a major role in finalizing the event.

On October 30th, 2014, the IEC and the TC will give a concert at the Thessaloniki Concert Hall-Megaro Mousikis Thessalonikis. Each choir will have their own performance first, followed by one Greek and one Turkish song which they will sing together. We will honor Nazım Hikmet in the city he was born in, by a special musical repertoire based on his poems.

On January 17th, 2015, the IEC and the TC will perform the same concert honouring the birthday of Nazım Hikmet in Istanbul.

What is the Thessaloniki Project?

Future Plans for the Project

This event could become the start of an annual festival between these two cities, involving different groups, enriched by workshops and topped off with cultural and musical exchange opportunities among classical music lovers.

We hope you will embrace our ambitious venture and support us in turning it into an event with a gradually expanding potential, in the name of **Friendship** and **Peace** between countries, **two values that have recently been of crucial importance.**



What does IEC sing?

Among many of the other major choral works, IEC has sung:

- DVORÁK, Antonin Stabat Mater, Op 58
- DONIZETTI, Gaetano Missa di Requiem
- HAENDEL, George Friedrich Messiah
- MOZART, Wolfgang Amadeus Ave Verum Corpus, Motet KV 618
Requiem Mass in D minor K.626
- PUCCINI, Giacomo Messa di Gloria
- SAYGUN, A. Adnan Yunus Emre Oratorio
- VIVALDI, Antonio Gloria, RV 589
Magnificat, RV 610
Beatus Vir, RV 597



A brief of retrospective of IEC concerts

Some of the significant concerts performed with orchestra among many of the others:

«In memory of 100th Death Anniversary of A.Dvořák»

Dvorak - Stabat Mater Op. 58

Venue: Ataturk Cultural Center (AKM) Concert Hall

Date: October 15 & 16, 2004

Orchestra: Istanbul State Symphony Orchestra

Conductor: Petr Vronsky

Hagia Irene «Opening Concert»

W.A. Mozart - Große Messe in c Moll, KV 427

Venue: Hagia Irene (Aya Irini)

Date: October 7, 2005

Orchestra: Istanbul State Symphony Orchestra

Conductor: Vesna Šouc

«New Year Concert»

Carl Orff – Carmina Burana

Venue: Ataturk Cultural Center (AKM) Concert Hall

Date: January 4 & 5, 2008

Orchestra: Istanbul State Symphony Orchestra

Conductor: Alexander Rahbari

«2010 European Capital of Culture»

L. van Beethoven 9th Symphony, "An die Freude",
Schlusschor, Op. 125

Adnan Saygun - Choral Works from Yunus Emre Oratorio

Venues and dates:

M.K.M. Concert Hall, Istanbul, April 8, 2010

Christuskirche Bochum, Essen, April 23, 2010

Gemeinschaftshaus Wulfen, Dorsten, Essen, April 24, 2010

Orch. & Guest Choir: Confido Vocale & Camerata, Germany

Conductor: Bodo Saborowsky

Cantata from «Yunus» to «Nazım» - World Premiere Performance

Hasan Yükselir & Fırat Yükselir - Yunus'tan Nazım'a Kantat

Venue: Eskişehir, Büyükşehir Belediyesi Sanat ve Kültür Sarayı

Date: May 21 & 22, 2010

Orch.: Eskişehir Metropolitan Municipality Symp. Orchestra

Conductor: Fırat Yükselir

Thessaloniki Concert Program

IEC - Turkish Composers & NAZIM HIKMET's Poetry

(Nazim, one of the most significant Turkish poet, was born in Thessaloniki and we would like to hail the city in this way)

- a. Fazil Say – Memleketim, Aclarin Gozbebekleri, Hirosima and Yatar Bursa Kalesi'nde
- b. Mesud Cemil (arranged by Emre Orhon) – Kanatlari Gumus
- c. Volkan Akkoc – Ben Bir Ceviz Agaciyim
- d. Ozan Baysal – Kiz Cocugu
- e. Mahmut Abra – Davet, Sen and Yapraklara Dallara.

IEC - Classical program

- a. Morten Lauridsen - Dirait-on
- b. Gabriel Faure - Cantique De Jean Racine
- c. Franz Liszt - Tu Es Petrus

ISTANBUL EUROPEAN CHOIR & THESSALONIKIS CHOIR singing together

- a. Ahmet Adnan Saygun - Yunus Emre Oratorium No.13 -Sensin Kerim Sensin Rahim
- b. Christos Leontis - Ke Na Aderfe Mou. (Giannis Ritsos)

IEC Conductor and Répétiteur

Conductor – Burak Onur Erdem

Burak Onur Erdem has a bachelor in Political Science from Bogazici University with Rectorate Prize and a master of arts in Music from ITU. He continues his doctoral studies on Conducting in ITU Center for Advanced Studies in Music in Istanbul. He has initiated many choral projects in Turkey, including choral festivals, conducting courses and choir exchanges.

Being one of the founders of Choral Culture Association, he pursues innovation in Turkish choral life. He is also conducting Istanbul-based chamber choir Rezonans and regularly performs with State Polyphonic Choir as a guest conductor.

He holds the position of Vice-Chair at European Choral Association Youth Committee. He has been the new conductor of Istanbul European Choir since Fall 2013.



IEC Conductor and Répétiteur

Répétiteur, Pianist – Lena Şenol

Lena Şenol was born in Kharkov city in Ukraine. Lena started her piano training at the age of four. As well as her piano soloist performances in Kharkov State conservatory and Kharkov Music College, she has accompanied Kharkov Teachers Symphony Orchestra, TRT Ankara Polyphonic Choir, Sevda Cenap And Music Foundation's Women Choir and Çanakkale 18 Mart University choir.

Additionally she performed during the soloist and group concerts conducted under the patronage of universities, municipalities and other public agencies to be held in Ankara, İzmir, Çanakkale, Tekirdağ and İstanbul. She worked for Istanbul State Opera and Ballet from 2006 to 2011.

She has been teaching at Halic University Conservatory since 2011. She also accompanies TRT Youth Choir and the Istanbul European Choir.



Sponsorship Items

Needs for the trip to Thessaloniki from 29/10 to 2/11

- Approximately: 70 - 80 people (65 choir + family members)
- Transportation in busses TR - GR return GR - TR (2 busses)
- Transportation within Thessaloniki (Rehearsals - concert - receptions - sightseeing)
- Flight tickets for soloists and conductor
- Accommodation (hotel for 4 nights)
- Food and Beverage
- Meals - snacks - during 2 rehearsals and the concert (before or after)
- 1 dinner- buffet
- 1 taverna - lunch .
- Cocktail on concert day
- Sight seeing - professional guiding for the whole group
- Museum entrance
- 1 night program - live traditional music
- Advertisement both in Istanbul and Thessaloniki (flyers&posters)

We estimate the total cost will be 20.000 Euro.*

* According to the area of business and capabilities of the sponsor candidate company, IEC can prepare a sponsorship package, composed of appropriate sponsorship items with exact costs for each item.

Benefits for Sponsors

- Having the support of both consulate and Municipality, the concert will attract a lot of attention on media both TV and Radio
- **Advertising Possibilities**, in any form (Printed material, flyers, products, advertising items)
- **Banners, booth** in the concert hall
- **Flash Banners** on our website and content on social media accounts of both choirs.
- **Company Promotional Materials or Products** to be delivered at the concert hall
- **T-shirts:** Members and guests of both choirs will mark their presence in the city wearing SPECIALLY DESIGNED T-SHIRTS, sponsor company logos will be printed on the t-shirts.
- **On-demand workshop organization** in the sponsor company as an internal event (for grand sponsors)



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Thank you!